

L2A™

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(c) Bilateral descent

also define by my thinks

Bilateral descent or kindred is a kind of kinship relation ~~between~~ a person associates with collaterals i.e. matrilaterals and patrilaterals

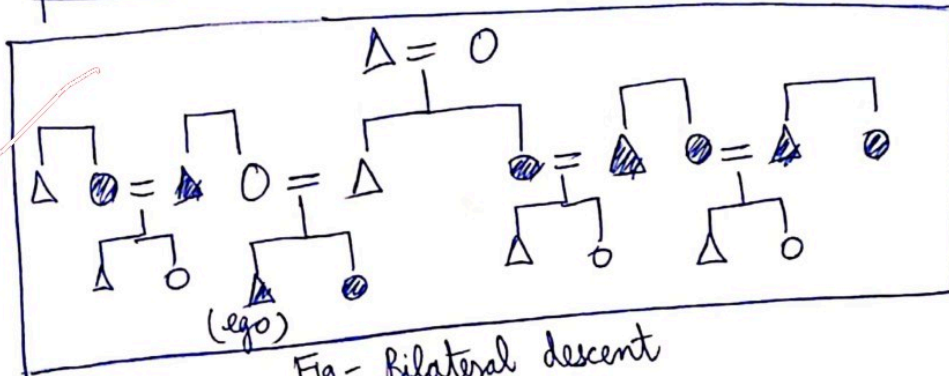


Fig- Bilateral descent

- 1) It is not true descent as descent is traced through lineage not collaterals.
- 2) Descent is ancestor-centric while kindred is ego centric
- 3) Bilateral descent is temporary and ends with death of ego.

Functions of Bilateral descent

1) Collaterals have important role to play during rites de passage.

eg: 'Bhaat' ceremony in Hindu marriages is performed by matrilaterals.

2) Help at the time of contingency or emergency.

3) Strengthening kinship bonds and increased cooperation.

4) Improved social relations among collaterals lead to complimentary filiation relations.

Hence, bilateral descent in a way helps to increase social cooperation in the society.

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